



CONFIDENTIAL · MANAGEMENT BRIEFING

Kastros HR Platform

Comprehensive product overview — capabilities delivered for workforce management across UAE, Karachi, and Multan operations.

Document version: 1.0 · Platform: Kastros HR (Next.js + Firebase)
Prepared for executive and board review

Executive summary

Kastros HR is a secure, browser-based human resources platform built for Kastros Group. It centralises employee records, time off, expenses, compliance documents, learning, performance data, and hiring in one system — with role-based access for employees, HR administrators, and the CEO.

What leadership gains: Real-time visibility of headcount, leave pipeline, open recruitment, training compliance, and probation milestones — without spreadsheets or disconnected tools. HR gains a single source of truth for profiles, letters, ID cards, and audit history.

- **Deployed as a modern web application** (cloud-ready, Firebase authentication and data storage).
- **Multi-business unit** support: UAE, Karachi, Multan — with currency defaults (AED / PKR).
- **End-to-end employee lifecycle:** public job applications → HR hire → onboarding → daily self-service → offboarding data.
- **Built-in compliance:** policy acknowledgements, Conflict of Interest (Col) workflow, document library, audit log.
- **Employee enablement:** public how-to manual and in-app help — no login required for training material.

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1. Platform & security

Technology foundation

- **Application:** Next.js 15 web application — responsive for desktop and tablet use.
- **Authentication:** Firebase Auth (work email + password); role enforced via secure session and custom claims (Employee, HR Admin, CEO).
- **Data:** Firestore (production) with structured HR store — employees, leave, expenses, documents, training, cases, audit, etc.

- **File storage:** Firebase Storage (and local fallback for development) for CVs, receipts, profile photos, policy files, Col submissions.
- **Hosting:** Designed for Vercel or equivalent cloud deployment with environment-based configuration.

Security controls

- Route-level access control — users only see modules permitted for their role.
- File downloads authorised per document type (own files, manager scope, or HR-wide).
- Audit trail of material actions (who changed what and when).
- CEO-only role promotion — prevents unauthorised elevation to HR Admin.
- Password reset via Firebase — onboarding emails for new hires when mail is configured.

2. User roles & access

Role	Typical users	Access scope
Employee	All staff	Own overview, leave, expenses, documents (policies & Col), training, own performance reviews, org chart (view). Cannot access other employees' HR records or admin setup.
HR Admin	People Operations	Full HR module set: People directory, onboarding, recruiting, settings, organization, letters, cases, approvals, compensation entry, document management.
CEO	Executive leadership	Same as HR Admin plus executive dashboard (company-wide KPIs), leave sign-off where required (Pending CEO), and Firebase role management.

3. Complete feature catalogue

The platform is organised into the following modules (sidebar groups in the application).

Overview

- **Dashboard (Overview):** Role-specific home — employees see profile summary, leave balance estimate, goals count, quick links; HR/CEO see headcount, pending leave, jobs, cases, probation alerts; CEO sees additional company pulse metrics.
- **My leave:** Leave balances by type and year; submit requests; track approval status; HR manages entitlements and approves/denies.
- **Expense claims:** Submit claims with category, amount, currency, receipt; HR approves, rejects, marks reimbursed (Paid).

People

- **People (directory):** Searchable roster; full employee profiles; inline edit for HR; CNIC expiry alerts.
- **Onboarding:** Add team member — creates employee + Firebase login; comprehensive intake form.
- **Recruiting:** Job postings; applicant pipeline; public apply link; CV and attachment review.
- **Transfer / Posting:** Record cross-business unit and department moves with effective dates.
- **Reporting channel:** Live org chart from "Reports to" manager email on each profile.

Time & performance

- **Performance:** Formal review records (cycle, grade, criteria, comments); HR/CEO record reviews; employees view own history.
- **Learning (training):** Assign training with due dates; internal/external provider; upload materials (PDF/PPT); track Required/Done and attendance.

Letters & documents

- **Letters:** HR letter repository (promotion, termination, etc.); printable views; appointment letter quick-generate from profile.
- **Documents:** Company library; policy manual acknowledgements; Col template upload and employee signed submissions; register personnel files.
- **HR cases:** Confidential case log for investigations and employee relations matters.

Setup & administration

- **Organization setup:** Business units, departments, sub-departments, job descriptions.
- **Settings:** Leave policy (types and default days); salary allowance catalog; demo reset (non-production).
- **Security:** Audit log viewer for compliance spot-checks.

External & support surfaces

- **Public careers portal:** /apply/[jobId] — candidates apply without login.
- **Training manual (public):** /training-manual/how-to — Employee vs HR/CEO guides with search; no login.
- **In-app help:** Floating help button opens manual in new tab while using the system.

4. Employee experience (self-service)

Every employee with a work email and profile can:

- Sign in securely and set password via HR-triggered reset email.
- View personal dashboard: job title, department, manager, joining date, probation reminder, estimated annual leave remaining.
- Request leave with type, date range, and notes; follow status through HR/CEO approval chain.
- Submit expense claims with receipt attachment and currency selection (AED, PKR, USD).
- Acknowledge company policies from the policy manual with timestamped record.
- Download Col template, sign offline, upload signed declaration.
- View assigned training, open materials, complete compliance programmes.
- View own performance review history.
- View reporting channel to understand team structure.
- Use public how-to manual (employee path) for step-by-step guidance.

5. HR & CEO operations (detailed)

People & profiles

HR maintains a rich employee record including:

- Identity: name, salutation, gender, DOB, nationality, marital status, religion, CNIC, address
- Employment: title, department, sub-department, location, BU, type, status, joining, probation
- Reports to (manager email), employee ID for card
- Phones, emergency contact, family/COI declaration
- Vehicle & licence details where applicable
- Statutory flags: Gratuity, EOBI, Provident Fund
- Profile photo (ID card)
- Education & certification records with files
- Personnel documents linked to individual
- Policy acknowledgement on behalf of employee when needed

HR actions on profiles: Edit profile (inline), resend password reset, generate appointment letter, print corporate ID card, manage salary/compensation with configurable allowances, add/remove academic and document records.

Leave administration

- Configure leave types and standard days per year in Settings.
- Apply defaults to all employees for a calendar year.
- Override per-employee entitlements on Leave page.
- Approve or deny requests; Pending HR → Pending CEO → Approved/Denied workflow.
- Company-wide pending count on executive dashboard.

Expense administration

- Review all employee claims with receipt preview.
- Approve or reject with audit trail.
- Mark Approved claims as Paid when finance completes reimbursement.

- Dashboard counts for pending review and approved-awaiting-payment.

Onboarding & offboarding data

- Single flow creates roster entry and Firebase account.
- Recommended top-down hire order for correct org chart.
- Email change on profile can sync to authentication (identity update).
- Employee status: Active, On leave, Offboarding, Separated.

6. Talent acquisition

- **Job management:** Create roles with description; share public application URL.
- **Applicant tracking:** Table of candidates per job; status; expand full application (education rows, cover letter, LinkedIn, experience).
- **Attachments:** CV, education certificate, other certs — stored and viewable by HR.
- **Decisions:** Approve or reject applications.
- **Hire path:** Approved candidates onboarded via HR form (internal fields: department, manager, joining date, probation, BU — not collected on public form).
- **LinkedIn kit:** Supporting collateral for external job posts (where configured in UI).

7. Compensation & benefits data

- **Per-employee compensation** (HR/CEO only on People profile): gross salary, basic salary, currency, multiple allowance lines.
- **Allowance catalog** in Settings: configurable types (e.g. fuel in liters, housing allowance) — HR defines catalog, applies per employee.
- **Appointment letter** can pull saved gross salary when generating letters.
- **Statutory flags** on profile (Gratuity, EOBI, PF) support letter generation and local compliance context.
- Display formatting with thousands separators for clarity.

8. Compliance & documents

- **Policy manual:** Versioned policies; employees acknowledge in-app; HR can record acknowledgement for paper sign-offs.
- **Company library:** HR-published notices and templates visible organisation-wide; preview and print.
- **Personnel files:** Contracts, visas, certificates — linked to named employee, not mixed into company library.
- **Col programme:** HR uploads master template; employees submit signed copies; HR reviews registry.
- **File security:** Authorised download only — linked to employee, document, application, training, or expense receipt.

9. Governance, audit & support

Audit & accountability

- Security module exposes chronological audit log (actor, action description, timestamp).
- Material HR mutations logged: onboarding, leave decisions, expense status, document registration, role changes, etc.

Executive controls (CEO)

- Company pulse dashboard: active headcount, on leave, departments, pending leave company-wide, open jobs, new applications, open training.
- Role manager: promote/demote Employee ↔ HR Admin ↔ CEO in Firebase (effective after re-login).

- Probation alerts: employees within 10 days of probation end — proactive HR action.

Training & adoption

- Public manual with Employee / HR/CEO paths and search — shareable by email without credentials.
- Direct links: ?role=employee or ?role=hr for targeted comms.
- In-app ? help button on every authenticated page.
- This PDF: full management overview of delivered capabilities.

10. Feature matrix (at a glance)

Capability	Employee	HR Admin	CEO
Dashboard / overview	Own	Team + alerts	Company pulse
Leave request	Yes	Approve	Approve + CEO queue
Expense claim	Submit	Approve / Paid	Approve / Paid
Policy acknowledge	Yes	Record for others	Record for others
Col submit	Yes	Template upload	Template upload
People directory	—	Full	Full
Onboarding / hire	—	Yes	Yes
Recruiting	—	Yes	Yes
Salary / allowances	—	Yes	Yes
Letters & ID card	—	Yes	Yes
Training assign	View own	Assign all	Assign all
Performance reviews	View own	Create	Create
HR cases	—	Yes	Yes
Settings / org setup	—	Yes	Yes
Audit log	—	View	View
Change user roles	—	—	Yes
Org chart	View	View	View
Public apply / manual	Apply / read	Manage / read	Manage / read

Conclusion: Kastros HR delivers an integrated people operations platform aligned to multi-location trading operations — combining employee self-service, HR operational control, executive visibility, and compliance workflows in one secure system. The solution is live, extensible, and supported by role-based training materials for sustainable adoption.

For technical or access questions, contact your People Operations lead. To regenerate this PDF after platform updates, run `npm run docs:pdf` from the project repository.